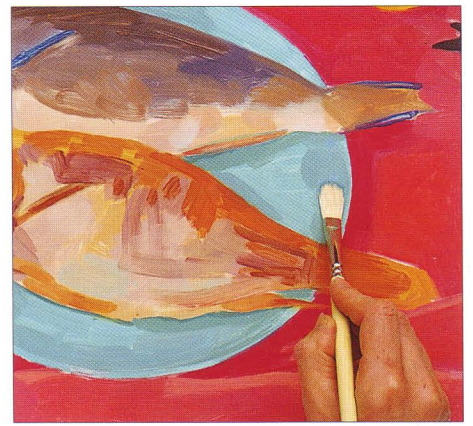


BRIGHT, SATURATED colors such as Cerulean Blue, left, produce high-key works that are light and optimistic in tone, but which can also be richly textured. High-key scenes are usually painted

on white or near-white grounds that illuminate thinly applied colors to achieve high-key effects. Transparent high-key paints can be used opaquely by adding a little white paint to bring the color out.

1 ▶ The white surface of this panel helps to keep the colors that are painted over it as bright and as luminous as possible. Paint the first coats of thin mid-toned color with a medium-sized filbert brush. Keep the colors as pure and as intense as possible.



2 ▲ Use a smaller brush and a mix of Manganese Blue, Cerulean Blue, and Viridian, together with a touch of Titanium White, to strengthen the bright but cool color of the plate.



3 ◀ Paint bright markings on top of the initial thin layers of color to give the fish better definition. The first layers of individual color should have created a sufficient sense of shape and tone on each fish.

4 ▶ As the composition is built up, less white paint is mixed into each color so that the last layers look transparent and strong. Add final highlights of thick, stiff white paint with a medium-sized or small brush.



Parrot Fish

This work has bright, saturated colors, mixed mainly from primaries and secondaries, so that they retain their purity and strength.

Strong saturated color produces a heightened, vibrant atmosphere.

Complementary colors enhance each other to make the painting appear even more luminous and strong.



Jane Gifford

